

CHAPTER – 1A

TRAFFIC ACCIDENTS

Introduction

India has a well-knit and coordinated system of transport which plays an important role in development of economic activities by promoting fair distribution of produced goods and services and movement of people. The share of transport sector in Gross Domestic Product (GDP) of India is steadily growing. It is one of the key indicators in assessment of socio-economic development of the country. Since traffic accidents are indicator of bottlenecks and other hindrances in smooth flow of traffic, hence NCRB collects detailed data on traffic accidents including road accidents for inferring the trend and patterns of traffic accidents for the planners to devise appropriate preventive strategies.

The Bureau collects data on 'Traffic Accidents' comprising of (i) Road Accidents (ii) 'Railway Accidents' and 'Incidents on Railway Tracks/ In Railway Premises' and (iii) Railway Crossing Accidents, as these are the major contributors of accidental deaths.

Number of 'Traffic Accidents' in the country have increased from 4,91,190 in 2023 to 4,95,256 in 2024. (The rate of deaths in road accidents per thousand vehicles has increased from 0.53 in 2023 to 0.54 in 2024). Maximum increase in number of traffic accidents cases in States from 2023 to 2024 was reported in Mizoram (from 47 to 69) followed by Meghalaya (from 232 to 268), Telangana (from 23,673 to 26,503), Puducherry (from 1,317 to

1,440) and Chhattisgarh (from 14,003 to 15,270). [Table–1A.1].

These traffic accidents resulted in injuries to 4,51,597 persons and 1,99,443 deaths during 2024. State of Uttar Pradesh (27,071 deaths) followed by Tamil Nadu (20,390 deaths) and Maharashtra (19,475 deaths) have reported maximum fatalities in traffic accidents in the country; these 3 States accounted for 13.6%, 10.2% and 9.8% of total deaths in traffic accidents respectively and collectively accounted for 33.6% (66,936 out of 1,99,443) of total fatalities reported at all India level during 2024.

The percentage share of traffic accidental deaths in total deaths due to 'Other Causes' has increased from 39.9% in 2020 to 43.4% in 2024. A rising trend was seen in total number of deaths in 'Traffic Accidents' from 2020 to 2021 with rising trend in 2022, which has increased in 2023 but this number in 2023 is more than that in 2020 & 2021. In 2024, it raised to 1,99,443. Total number of Accidental deaths have increased by 0.8% (from 1,97,871 to 1,99,443) in 2024 over 2023. [LIST-1A.1].

These traffic accidents comprise of 4,67,967 road accidents, Nil railway accidents, 25,397 incidents on railway Tracks/ in railway premises and 1,892 railway crossing accidents and caused 1,75,142, 0, 22,413 and 1,888 deaths respectively during 2024.

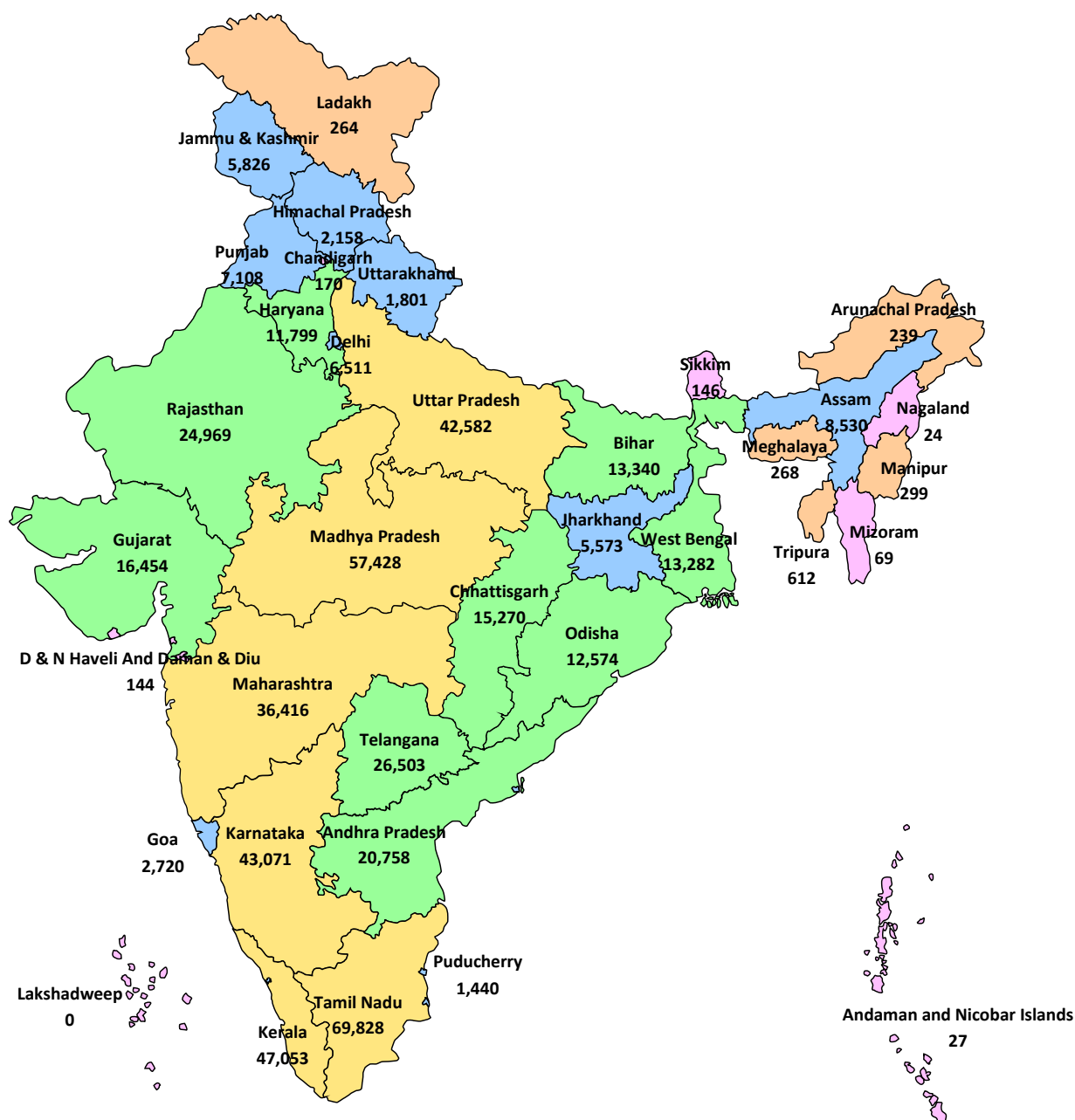
LIST-1A.1

Number and Share of Deaths due to Traffic Accidents during 2020 – 2024

Sl. No.	Year	Number of Accidental Deaths						Percentage Share of 'Traffic Accidental Deaths' in Accidental Deaths due to 'Other Causes'
		Road Accidents	Railway Accidents	Incidents on Railway Tracks / In Railway Premises	Railway Crossing Accidents	Total Traffic Accidents	Total Accidental Deaths due to 'Other Causes'	
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(6)	(7)	(8)
1	2020	1,33,201	214	11,754	1,185	1,46,354	3,66,992	39.9
2	2021	1,55,622	108	16,323	1,807	1,73,860	3,90,404	44.5
3	2022	1,71,100	3	20,789	2,455	1,94,347	4,22,444	46.0
4	2023	1,73,826	14	21,789	2,242	1,97,871	4,37,660	45.2
5	2024	1,75,142	0	22,413	1,888	1,99,443	4,59,954	43.4

- As per data provided by States/UTs.

FIGURE-1A.1
STATE/UT – WISE TRAFFIC ACCIDENT CASES DURING 2024



• As per data provided by States/UTs.

Traffic Accident Cases

- upto 200
- 201 to 1000
- 1001 to 10000
- 10001 to 30000
- Above 30000

FIGURE-1A.2
STATE/UT – WISE TRAFFIC ACCIDENT DEATHS DURING 2024



• As per data provided by States/UTs.

Traffic Accident Deaths



Month - wise patterns of traffic accidents reveal that maximum number of 'Traffic Accidents' have occurred in the month of May which accounted for 8.8%. The month-wise break-up of 'Traffic Accidents' for each State/UT/City are presented in **Table-1A.5**.

Time of occurrence - wise analysis of traffic accidents reveal that maximum number of 'Traffic Accidents' have taken place during 18:00 hrs. to 21:00 hrs. and 15:00 hrs. to 18:00 hrs., accounting for 20.4% (1,01,232) and 17.1% (84,837) of total traffic accidents (4,95,256) respectively during the year 2024. State/UT wise 'Traffic Accidents' by time of occurrence is presented in **Table-1A.6**.

Road Accidents

The Bureau has made an effort to capture comprehensive information on road accidents using the revised proformae and published the first report for the year 2014 and this edition is eleventh in the series.

A total of 4,67,967 road accident cases were reported during 2024. Road accident cases in the country have increased from 4,64,029 in 2023 to 4,67,967 in 2024 [**Table-1A.1**]. The fatalities in road accidents have increased by 0.8% (from 1,73,826 in 2023 to 1,75,142 in 2024). The **LIST-1A.1** can be

referred to see the patterns of 'Road Accidental Deaths'.

The number of vehicles, number of road accidents along with resultant fatalities and injuries therefrom, their percentage variations over previous year and the rate of accidental deaths per thousand vehicles during the last five years are presented in **LIST-1A.2**. It is observed that the rate of deaths per thousand vehicles in 2024 has increased from 0.53 in 2023 to 0.54 in 2024.

4,67,967 road accidents caused 1,75,142 deaths and injuries to 4,48,365 persons during 2024. Generally road accidents have caused more injuries than deaths, but in A & N Islands, Mizoram, Jharkhand, Punjab and Bihar, road accidents caused more deaths compared to persons injured. In A & N Islands, 27 road accidents caused 31 deaths & injuries to 28 persons, in Mizoram, 69 road accidents caused 73 deaths & injuries to 64 persons, in Jharkhand, 5,196 road accidents caused 4,114 deaths & injuries to 3,266 persons, in Punjab, 6,166 road accidents caused 4,936 deaths & injuries to 3,407 persons, and in Bihar, 11,528 road accidents caused 9,218 deaths & injuries to 6,600 persons. [**Table-1A.2**].

LIST-1A.2

Growth in Number of Vehicles and Road Accidents in India (2020 – 2024)

Sl. No.	Year	Road Accidents (in thousand)	% Variation over Previous Year	Persons Injured (in thousand)	% Variation over Previous Year	Persons died (in Nos.)	% Variation Over Previous Year	No. of Vehicles (In Thousand)#	% Variation over previous Year	Rate of Deaths per thousand Vehicles (Col.7/Col.9)
(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)	(9)	(10)	(11)
1	2020	354.8	-18.9	335.1	-23.7	1,33,201	-13.9	2,95,772	-	0.45
2	2021	403.1	13.6	371.9	11.0	1,55,622	16.8	2,95,772*	-	0.53
3	2022	446.8	10.8	423.2	13.8	1,71,100	9.9	3,26,299	10.3	0.52
4	2023	464.0	3.9	448.0	5.9	1,73,826	1.6	3,26,299*	-	0.53
5	2024	468.0	0.8	448.4	0.1	1,75,142	0.8	3,26,299*	-	0.54

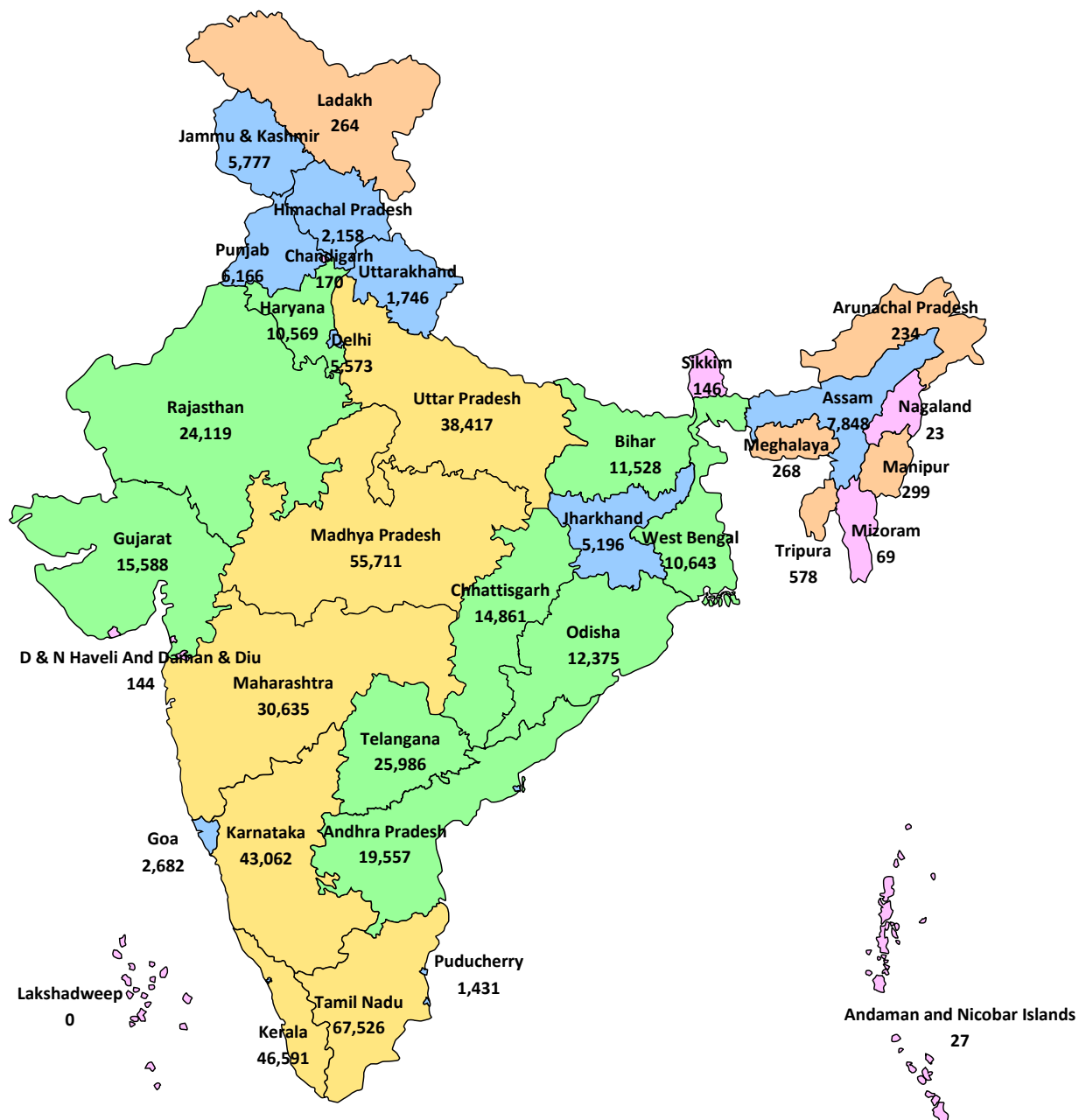
'#' Source: Road Accidents in India - 2023, TRW, MoRT&H, as per latest published data.

'*' figures of the previous year used due to non-availability of data.

'+' for calculation, figures of previous year regarding number of vehicles has been used due to unavailability of data.

- As per data provided by States/UTs.

FIGURE-1A.3
STATE/UT – WISE ROAD ACCIDENT CASES DURING 2024



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Road Accident Cases

- upto 200
- 201 to 1000
- 1001 to 10000
- 10001 to 30000
- Above 30000

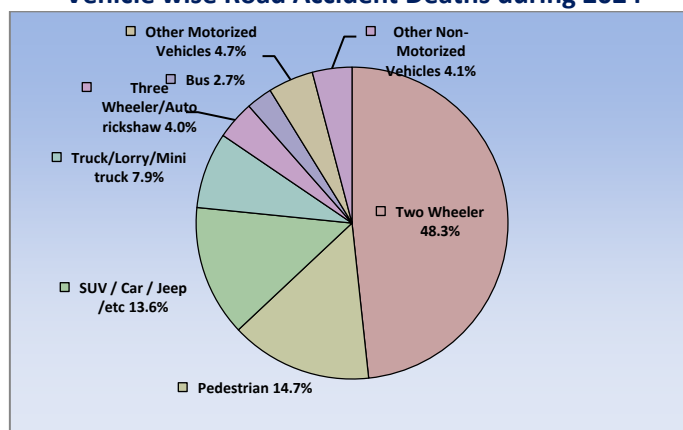
During 2024, two wheelers have accounted for maximum fatal road accidents (84,599 deaths), contributing 48.3% of total road accidental deaths, followed by Pedestrian (25,769 deaths) (14.7%) and Cars (23,739 deaths) (13.6%) [Table-1A.3].

Majority of deaths due to two wheelers accidents were reported in Tamil Nadu (11,786 deaths) and Uttar Pradesh (8,575 deaths), accounting for 13.9% and 10.1% of total deaths due to two wheeled vehicles respectively. Large number of deaths due to SUV/car/jeep accidents (4,575 out of 23,739) were reported in Uttar Pradesh (19.3%) of total such accidents and large number of deaths due to trucks/lorries/mini truck accidents (3,628 out of 13,815) were reported in Uttar Pradesh,

accounting for 26.3%. 29.8% (1,462 out of 4,903) and 8.0% (394 out of 4,903) of total fatal road accidents due to buses were reported in Uttar Pradesh and Karnataka respectively. Deaths of 16.2% (4,176 out of 25,769) of pedestrians in road accidents were reported in Tamil Nadu during 2024 [Table-1A.4].

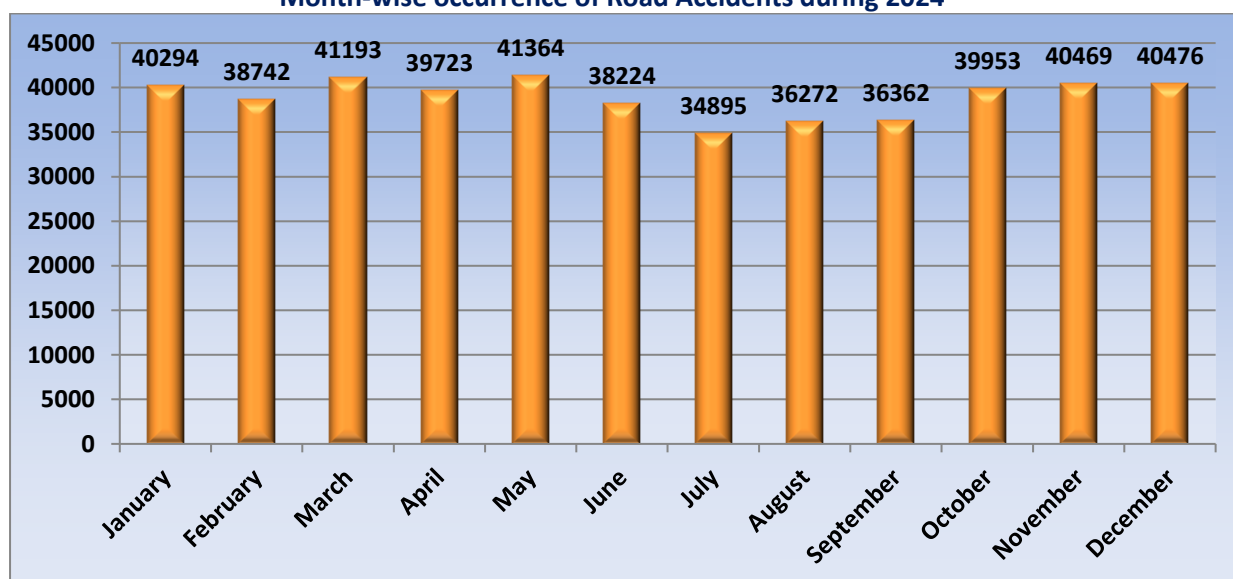
The month-wise distribution of 'Road Accidents' shows that most of road accidents were reported in the month of May (41,364 cases), contributing 8.8% of total road accidents. Majority of accidents in this month (May) have been reported in Tamil Nadu, accounting for 13.6% of total accidents reported (5,640 out of 41,364 cases) in the month of May [Table-1A.5].

FIGURE-1A.4
Vehicle wise Road Accident Deaths during 2024



Other Motorised Transport includes Tractor etc.

FIGURE-1A.5
Month-wise occurrence of Road Accidents during 2024



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Most of road accidents (97,349 out of 4,67,967 cases) were reported during 18:00 hrs. to 21:00 hrs. (Night), accounting for 20.8% of total road accidents. During 18:00 hrs. to 21:00 hrs. (Night), majority of road accidents were reported in Tamil Nadu (16,823 cases), Madhya Pradesh (11,208 cases) and Kerala (9,711 cases). Time period '15:00 hrs. to 18:00 hrs. (Day)' and '12:00 hrs. to 15:00 hrs. (Day)' accounted for 17.4% (81,209 cases) and 14.8% (69,279 cases) of total road accidents during 2024 [Table-1A.6].

Road-wise classification of accidents is presented in Table-1A.7. As per road classification, the National Highways which has a share of only 2.1% of total road length* (1.32 Lakh KMs out of 63.3 Lakh KMs) accounted for highest road accidents, contributing 29.8% of total road accidents. State Highways having the share of 2.8% (1.80 Lakh KMs) of total road length have reported 22.0% of road accidents in the country. However, a considerable number of road accidents were also reported on other roads. These accounted for 48.2% of total such accidents during 2024.

A total of 3,586 cases of road accidents were also reported on Expressways which caused injuries to 3,128 persons and deaths of 2,119 persons. The highest numbers of deaths in road accidents were reported on the

National Highways accounting for 34.8% (60,894 out of 1,75,142) followed by State Highways (23.0%) (40,355 deaths). A total of 73,893 (42.2%) persons died due to road accidents on the other roads during 2024.

State/UT-wise patterns revealed that maximum fatalities in road accidents on the National Highways took place in Uttar Pradesh (12.5%) (7,621 out of 60,894 deaths) followed by Tamil Nadu (10.4%) (6,359 deaths), Maharashtra (8.4%) (5,098 deaths), Madhya Pradesh (7.7%) (4,711 deaths) and Karnataka (6.8%) (4,145 deaths) during 2024.

Maximum number of accidents on State Highways in the country occurred in Tamil Nadu (21,688 cases). Maximum fatalities in road accidents on State Highways were reported in Tamil Nadu (6,099 out of 40,355 deaths) which accounted for 15.1% of total deaths due to road accidents on State Highways, followed by Uttar Pradesh (5,585) (13.8%) during 2024. Maximum fatalities on the Expressways were reported in Uttar Pradesh contributing 63.6% (1,348 out of 2,119) followed by Haryana (8.8%), Maharashtra (8.2%), Rajasthan (5.2%) and Karnataka (4.8%) during 2024. [Table-1A.7]

LIST-1A.3 Road Accidental Deaths in every 100 km - 2024 (Road Category wise)

Type of Road	2024				
	Length of Road (in KM*)	Road Accident Cases	Total Number of Deaths	Cases per 100 KM	Deaths per 100 KM
National Highways	1,32,499 [#]	1,39,433	60,894	105	46
State Highways	1,79,535 [#]	1,02,758	40,355	57	23
Other Roads	60,19,723 [#]	2,25,776	73,893	4	1
Total	63,31,757 [#]	4,67,967	1,75,142	7	3

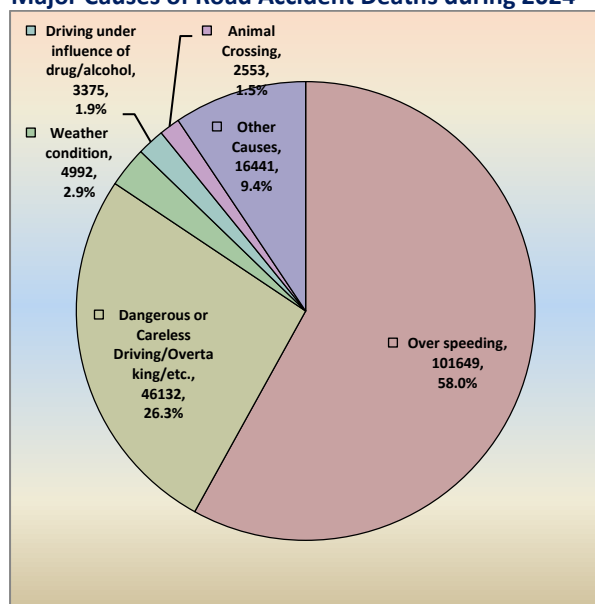
- As per data provided by States/UTs.

* Source: Road Accidents in India – 2023, Ministry of Road Transport & Highways.

figures of the previous year used due to non-availability of data.

Cause-wise distribution of road accidents (which also include unmanned railway crossing accidents) is presented in **Table-1A.8**. Cause-wise analysis of road accidents revealed that most of road accidents were due to over-speeding accounting for 61.2% of total accidents (2,86,325 out of 4,67,967 cases) which caused 1,01,649 deaths and injuries to 2,83,162 persons. Dangerous/careless driving or overtaking caused 1,21,502 accidents (26.0% of total accidents) which resulted in 46,132 deaths and injuries to 1,12,504 persons during 2024. 2.1% (9,913 out of 4,67,967 cases) of such accidents were due to poor weather condition. Driving under influence of drug/alcohol contributed 1.7% of total accidents which resulted in injuries to 7,435 persons & 3,375 deaths in the country.

FIGURE-1A.6
Major Causes of Road Accident Deaths during 2024



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Cause - wise analysis of fatal road accidents revealed that 58.0% (1,01,649 out of 1,75,142 deaths) and 26.3% (46,132 out of 1,75,142 deaths) of fatalities in road accidents were due to over-speeding and dangerous/careless driving or overtaking respectively. Poor weather condition, Driving under Influence of Drug/Alcohol and Animal Crossing caused 2.9% (4,992 deaths), 1.9% (3,375 deaths) and 1.5% (2,553 deaths) of total deaths due to road accidents respectively during 2024.

Large number of deaths in road accidents due to over-speeding was reported in Tamil Nadu (13.5%) (13,765 out of 1,01,649 deaths) followed by Karnataka (10.4%) (10,614 out of 1,01,649 deaths). Dangerous/careless driving or overtaking caused maximum fatalities in Uttar Pradesh (11,286 out of 46,132) which accounted for 24.5% of total deaths followed by 10.3% (4,739) deaths in Maharashtra. Maximum fatalities due to driving under influence of drug/alcohol were reported in Uttar Pradesh (36.4%) followed by Madhya Pradesh (13.2%), Odisha (10.6%), Maharashtra (5.2%) and Jharkhand (5.0%) during 2024 **[Table-1A.9]**.

NIL accidental deaths was reported at unmanned railways crossings. **[Table-1A.9]**.

Place of occurrence - wise patterns of road accidents reveal that 59.7% of total accidents have occurred in rural areas (2,79,412) and 40.3% in urban areas (1,88,555) out of 4,67,967 total cases during 2024. Both in rural as well as urban area most of the accidents were reported at places near residential area. 30.9% (86,477 out of 2,79,412 cases) accidents in rural area and 31.7% (59,732 out of 1,88,555 cases) in urban area have taken place near residential area. 6.1% of road accidents in urban area took place at pedestrian crossing (11,445 out 1,88,555 cases). Besides, 7.1% (32,994 out of 4,67,967 cases) of road accidents in the country have taken place near schools, college or other educational institutions **[Table-1A.10]**.

Uttar Pradesh followed by Bihar have reported 25.9% and 15.5% of total deaths due to road accidents near schools/college/other educational institutes in urban area respectively. Uttar Pradesh reported highest fatalities due to road accidents at places near to residential area (urban area) accounting for 15.3% (2,799 out of 18,261) of total such deaths during 2024 **[Table-1A.11]**.

FIGURE-1A.7
STATE/UT – WISE ROAD ACCIDENT DEATHS 2024



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

Road Accident Deaths



‘Railway Accidents’ and ‘Incidents on Railway Tracks/ In Railway Premises’

No case of ‘Railway Accident’ was reported during the year 2024. [Table-1A.1 & 1A.2].

A total of 25,397 cases of ‘Incidents on Railway Tracks/ In Railway Premises’ were reported, showing an increase of 2.9% during the year 2024 over 2023 (24,678). In 25,397 incidents caused injuries to 3,136 persons and 22,413 deaths during 2024 [Table-1A.1 & 1A.2].

Maximum cases of ‘Incidents on Railway Tracks/In Railway Premises’ were reported in Maharashtra accounting for 22.8% (5,781 out of 25,397 cases) followed by Uttar Pradesh (14.0%) (3,547 cases). These two States have also reported highest fatalities in Incident on ‘Railway Tracks/In Railway Premises’, accounting for 16.0% (3,587 out of 22,413 deaths) in Maharashtra and 15.8% (3,538 deaths) in Uttar Pradesh of total deaths in Incident on Railway Tracks/In Railway Premises respectively. 2,202 out of 3,136 persons injured in railway incidents/premises were reported in Maharashtra alone during 2024 [Table 1A.2].

The month-wise distribution of ‘Railway Accidents’ and ‘Incidents on Railway tracks/ In Railway Premises’ shows that most of accidents were reported in the month of October (2,244 cases), contributing 8.8% of total accidents. Maharashtra (523 out of 2,244 cases) has reported maximum incidents in the month of October, accounting for 23.3% of total such accidents. [Table-1A.5].

Most of ‘Railway accidents’ and ‘Incidents on railway tracks/ in railway premises’ (3,874 out of 25,397) have taken place during 06:00 hrs. to 09:00 hrs. (Day), accounting for 15.3% of total accidents. 15.0% (3,808 cases) incidents were reported during ‘09:00 hrs. to 12:00 hrs. (Day)’. Maharashtra has reported maximum incidents during 18:00 hrs. to 21:00 hrs. (Night) and 21:00 hrs. to 24:00 hrs. (Night), accounting for 15.5% (896 cases) and 15.1% (872 cases) respectively [Table-1A.6].

State/UT - wise classification of ‘Railway Accidents’ is presented in Table-1A.12.

State/UT - wise classification of ‘Incident on Railway Tracks/In Railway Premises’ is presented in Table-1A.13. The analysis of classification of incidents on ‘railway tracks/ in railway premises’ revealed that incidents of ‘Fall from Trains or Collision with People at Track’ constituted majority accidents (76.6%) (19,416 out of 25,397). State of Maharashtra has reported the majority of such cases, accounting for 28.9% (5,609 out of 19,416 cases) of total cases of Fall from trains or collision with people at track. A total of 17,029 persons died due to either fall from trains or collision with people at track, accounting for 76.0% of total deaths in ‘Incidents on railway tracks/ in railway premises’ (22,413 deaths).

State/UT - wise causes of ‘Railway accidents’ and ‘Incidents on railway tracks/ in railway premises’ is presented in Table-1A.14. The causes include Fault of Driver, Sabotage, Signalmen’s Error, Mechanical Failure and Other causes. Majority of cases comes under unclassified category ‘Other Causes’, a total of 25,391 out of 25,397 cases of ‘Railway accidents’ and ‘Incidents on railway tracks/ in railway premises’ were furnished under ‘Other Cause’ (fall of persons from trains, persons coming under trains etc. come under this category). During 2024, Fault from Driver caused 3 incidents in Uttar Pradesh and due to Mechanical defects (like poor design, track faults, bridge/tunnel collapse, etc.) caused 3 incidents in Tripura.

Maximum railway crossing accidents were reported in Uttar Pradesh accounting for 32.7% (618 out of 1,892 cases) followed by West Bengal (29.0%) (549 cases) and Kerala (13.7%) (260 cases). States of Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal and Kerala have reported highest fatalities in railway crossing accidents, accounting for 32.3% (610 out of 1,888 deaths), 29.1% (549 deaths) and 14.1% (267 deaths) respectively during 2024 [Table-1A.2].

Traffic Accidents in Cities

A total of 73,426 traffic accidents were reported in 53 cities during 2024. 73,426 traffic accidents caused injuries to 63,519 persons and 17,797 deaths. The maximum fatalities in traffic accidents was reported in Delhi City (2,181 deaths) followed by Jaipur (1,001 deaths) and Bengaluru (894 deaths) [Table-1A.2].

Road Accidents (71,239 cases) accounted for 97.0% of total traffic accidents in 53 mega cities during 2024. Delhi City accounted for 7.8% (5,573 out of 71,239 cases) of total road accidents reported in 53 mega cities followed by Bengaluru 6.7% (4,769 cases) and Hyderabad (5.3%) (3,785 cases). The large number of fatal road accidents were reported in Delhi City (1,551 deaths) followed by Bengaluru (894 deaths), accounting for 9.7% and 5.6% of total deaths due to road accidents in 53 mega cities respectively during 2024.

Cause-wise analysis of road accidents (including unmanned railway crossing) revealed that most of road accident deaths (including unmanned railway crossing) in 53 mega cities were due to over-speeding which accounted for 52.8% (8,418 out of 15,956 deaths) of total deaths due to road accidents during 2024. Dangerous or Careless driving/Over-taking etc. also caused 30.1% of total deaths due to road accidents (4,805 out

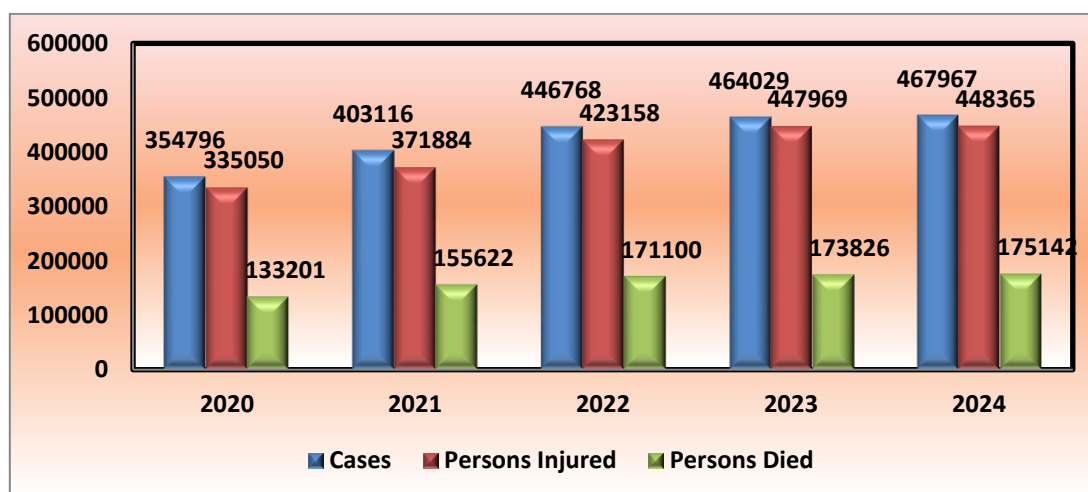
of 15,956 deaths). Driving under influence of drug/alcohol had caused 2.6% (411 out of 15,956 deaths) of fatalities in road accidents. Among 53 mega cities, most of fatalities due to driving under influence of drug/alcohol were reported in Agra (73 out of 411 deaths) [Table-1A.9].

Place of occurrence – wise deaths in road accidents reveals that most of fatalities due to road accidents have taken place near residential area, contributing 32.6% (5,194 out of 15,956 deaths) of deaths in road accidents in 53 mega cities, followed by 8.1% (1,291 out of 15,956 deaths) near recreation place/cinema hall and 7.4% near schools/ college/ other educational institutions (1,181 out of 15,956) deaths. Out of 53 mega cities, Ahmedabad (180 deaths) followed by Delhi City (147 deaths) have reported maximum cases of road accidents at pedestrian crossing. [Table-1A.11]. As per road-wise classification of road accidents, 17.8% of total road accidents in 53 mega cities were reported at the National Highways. 25.4% of fatalities in road accidents were reported at the National Highways during 2024 [Table-1A.7].

A total of 1,988 ‘railway accidents’ and ‘incidents on railway tracks/ in railway premises’ were reported in 53 mega cities where in Delhi City (933) has reported maximum incidents by contributing 46.9% of total accidents during 2024.

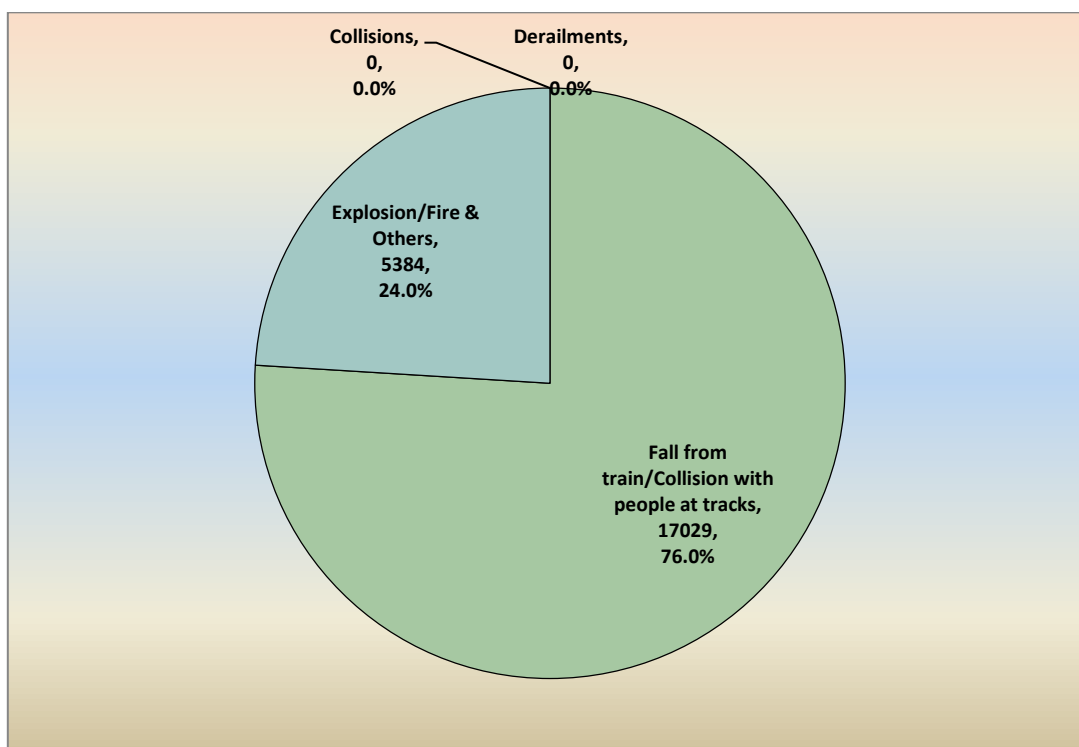
FIGURE–1A.8

Trend of Road Accident Cases, Persons Injured and Persons Died during 2020 – 2024



- As per data provided by States/UTs.

FIGURE–1A.9
Classification of ‘Railway Accidents’ and ‘Incidents on Railway Tracks
/ In Railway Premises’ Deaths during 2024



- As per data provided by States/UTs.
